In light of the above, the United States' other priorities, including Iran and Middle East peace, had to compete for the administration's attention and resources. Moreover, Obama's presidency focused more on domestic policy (health, unemployment, etc.) than on foreign policy.

As an aside, a jihadist revolution in Pakistan would fundamentally alter the rules of the game in the international system and pose a direct threat to Israel, since Pakistan was a Sunni terrorist state with much greater nuclear military deterrence and capability than Iran. It should be noted that, as part of President Obama's agreement with the Pakistani prime minister, the former renounced any say over the country's nuclear program. There was also an assessment that a military takeover of the country would precede a jihadi coup.

Obama's priorities being what they were, it was clearly not in the United States' interest to stir up any trouble in its relations with Iran. After the 2009 Iranian elections, some in the US administration voiced their belief that any American support of the opposition in Iran would be a "kiss of death" because pressuring Ahmadinejad while he was weak could be perceived as an attempt to exploit his vulnerability and increase hostility against the United States.

The prevailing assessment in government circles was that if Israel were to attack Iran and if it were to respond, the United States would not be able to stand by. But an attack on the United States or on its forces in Iraq or Afghanistan following Israeli action against Iran would cause serious damage to Israeli-US relations.

The United States-Pakistan-Afghanistan triangle had significant implications for Indian-Pakistani relations. The Indians were concerned over the weakness of the Pakistani regime. The Pakistanis feared that the Indians would exploit their weakness. In light of this, the Pakistanis gave up their nuclear safeguards, that is, the physical separation of their nuclear warheads and their means of delivery.[1] The Indians interpreted this as a sign of intent and raised their level of alertness. A possible outcome of this situation was the continuation of terrorist attacks in India originating in Pakistan, which would be followed by an Indian response, and then, potentially, escalation in the form of Pakistani nuclear readiness. An Israeli observer should be reminded that for a combination of economic, political, and demographic reasons, relations between India and Iran were close, and it was hard to imagine that the improvement of Israel's relations with India